Treaty which it signed with Germany during the conference.[137] As Gregory in the Foreign Office reported, the Soviet government was touting the invitation to the conference 'first as being tantamount to de jure recognition, and secondly as a complete victory of the Soviet Government over the Governments of the West'.[138]

It was as a result of this boost in confidence that the Bolshevik authorities appear to have once again begun its propaganda activities, particularly its support of anti-British nationalist movements.[139] Following protests by Curzon during the Anglo-Soviet trade agreement talks and his note of 1921, the Soviet government had been forced to temporarily pare back some of its more overt propaganda efforts, including the school for revolutionaries which had been set up in Tashkent by the Indian Communist M.N. Roy.[140] Despite this closure of Roy's school, however, there was always scant hope that the Bolshevik regime was going to completely give up its agitation among the people of Asia, and in April 1921 the Communist University of the Toilers of the East (KUTV) was founded in Moscow. Most of the students of Roy's were transferred to the Russian capital, although soon the university would set up departments in Tashkent, as well as Baku and Irkutsk.[141] Thus by December 1922, the new secretary of state for India, Lord Peel, was warning Reading of Bolshevik-sponsored sedition in India: 'The danger is increasing.'[142] Peel seems to be referring particularly to the growing activity of Roy, who since April had been in Berlin from where he kept up a continual stream of agitation against the Indian government. Despatching propaganda into India such as the newspaper The Vanguard of Indian Independence, and the pamphlets India in Transition, India's Problem and Its Solution and What Do We Want?, Roy was also devising various plans to send into India a number of the students from the KUTV.[143] It was probably these activities which Peel had in mind when he informed Reading in December 1922 of indications that the Bolsheviks were succeeding in smuggling literature and agents into India.[144]

Reading's reply to Peel's warning was calm and reassuring: 'We are fully alive to the necessity for exercising the closest watch over all Bolshevik activities directed against this country.' As the viceroy explained further, together with the provincial Criminal Intelligence Departments, there existed at Peshwar and Quetta Intelligence Bureaus which were specifically